

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit

Date	28 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3622
Project Name	Import Data Using Transform Maps
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT

- **HR Operations Teams & Data Administrators:** Responsible for onboarding new staff, updating employee records, and maintaining accurate organization details.
- **ServiceNow System Administrators:** Responsible for database hygiene, data integrity, platform configurations, and reporting.

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS

- **Jobs-to-be-Done:** Import large batches of employee data from Excel spreadsheets into the custom ServiceNow Employee Test (u_employee_test) table smoothly.
- **Problems:** Manual record entry is slow and error-prone. Standard imports without primary key validation create duplicate records on repeated uploads, corrupting the database.

3. TRIGGERS

- **High-Volume Hiring & Data Audits:** Rapid expansion requiring bulk updates, or internal audits revealing duplicate employee records.
- **Management Demands:** Executives requesting real-time visual summaries of employee distribution by department and location.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER

- **Before:** Frustrated by time-consuming manual data entry, anxious about introducing duplicate records during file re-uploads, and overwhelmed by lack of data visibility.
- **After:** Confident in seamless automated imports, relieved that existing records update automatically without duplicates, and empowered by live dashboard analytics.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS

- **Manual Entry:** Typing employee records row-by-row into ServiceNow forms (Time-consuming and prone to typos).
- **Basic Import Sets (Without Coalesce):** File uploads using standard import maps without field matching, resulting in duplicate rows for every re-upload.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

- **Access Permissions:** Creating backend dashboards via PA_DASHBOARDS.FORM requires setting Access Control List (ACL) Admin Overrides to True.
- **Technical Complexity:** HR staff need an automated pipeline that handles validation without requiring manual coding or database scripts.

7. BEHAVIOUR

- **Current Workflow:** HR teams compile employee information in Excel sheets (.xlsx / .csv) and send them to platform admins for data loading.
- **Pain Points:** Re-importing corrected spreadsheet files creates duplicate records instead of updating existing entries.

8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR

- **ONLINE:** ServiceNow Platform (Import Sets, Transform Maps, Reports, and Employee Analytics Dashboards).

- **OFFLINE:** Local Excel spreadsheet files containing employee data maintained offline prior to platform ingestion.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE

Import Transform Maps lacking a designated primary key configuration (Coalesce setting), causing ServiceNow to treat every imported row as a brand-new database insertion rather than matching and updating existing entries.

10. YOUR SOLUTION

- **Automated Import Pipeline:** Created a staging Import Set table and configured the Sample Spreadsheet Import Transform Map to target the Employee Test table.
- **Coalesce Validation:** Enabled Coalesce = True on the Employee ID field mapping to ensure existing records update and new ones insert automatically (0 duplicates created).
- **Reporting & Dashboards:** Built visual reports (Employees by Department, Employees by Location, Employee List Report) and consolidated them onto the Employee Analytics Dashboard for real-time visibility.